

How to quit strategically — Action Checklist

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KNOW YOUR TRUE NUMBERS

- ☐ **Know Your True Numbers:** List every fixed monthly expense including rent, utilities, insurance, minimum debt payments, groceries, and transportation with their exact dollar amounts rather than estimates or guesses.
- ☐ **Know Your True Numbers:** Review your last three months of bank and credit card statements to calculate your actual variable spending on dining out, subscriptions, shopping, and entertainment.
- ☐ **Know Your True Numbers:** Add your fixed expenses plus a realistic grocery and utility estimate plus fifteen percent for unexpected costs to determine your real survival number.
- ☐ **Know Your True Numbers:** Subtract your survival number from your current monthly income to identify your financial gap and see exactly how much you need to cover each month.

LEAVE WITHOUT GUILT

- ☐ **Leave Without Guilt:** Write a brief, professional resignation letter that expresses gratitude for the experience and provides a reasonable notice period instead of venting complaints or criticizing management.
- ☐ **Leave Without Guilt:** Deliver your resignation in person to your direct manager if possible rather than through email or text message so you maintain control of the narrative and leave on good terms.
- ☐ **Leave Without Guilt:** Document your ongoing projects, pending deadlines, and processes in a clear handover document so your team isn't stranded after you leave and you don't get dragged back in.
- ☐ **Leave Without Guilt:** Collect personal contact information from trusted colleagues before leaving because you may need professional references, networking connections, or advice in the future.

RECOVER BEFORE RETURNING

- ☐ **Recover Before Returning:** Structure your first weeks with intentional boundaries around sleep, meals, movement, and rest so your body actually recovers instead of just spinning without the pressure of work.
 - ☐ **Recover Before Returning:** Calculate how many months your savings will last at your survival spending rate so you can make decisions from a place of clarity instead of panic as time passes.
 - ☐ **Recover Before Returning:** Resist taking freelance or consulting work immediately because your body and mind need genuine rest, not just a different wrapper on the same exhausting pace.
 - ☐ **Recover Before Returning:** Before applying to anything, spend time reflecting on what type of work, environment, and boundaries you actually need so you don't just recreate the conditions that burned you out.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.